

THE PROBLEM LENA DESCRIBED

Fill the gap. Keep one clear promise.

Last-minute cancellations create empty appointments and repeated checking.

Today

Staff check Square, scan a Google Sheet, text a likely match, and wait. The stopping point is unclear.

The failure to avoid

Two clients once said yes to the same group text. Different staff replied, and a client arrived expecting the slot.

Lena's goal

Fewer empty slots, less chasing, and one visible appointment holder. Square remains the real calendar.

Agreed approach: oldest eligible request first, one client at a time for each opening.

HOW THE PROTOTYPE BEHAVES

Offer. Wait. Resolve. Keep staff informed.

Staff manage openings. Clients use a personal offer page with exact details and a deadline.

1 Add an opening

Staff enter the appointment details, reply window (default 15 minutes), and any practical cutoff.

2 Find a match

Match service, availability and stylist. Exclude opt-outs. Offer the oldest eligible request first.

3 Client responds

Clients accept, decline or ask a question on their offer page. Decline or the reply deadline moves to the next client.

4 Confirm one holder

A clear, valid acceptance reserves the slot here. Late replies get an explanation. Staff update Square.

Staff can cancel an offer and try the next person, or close the opening and stop. Temporal retains the wait and outcome when the worker restarts.

VERIFICATION AND PROTOTYPE BOUNDARIES

Checked behavior. Clearly stated limits.

26 automated tests passed, plus 14 browser checks across staff and client pages.

What passed

Staff: Lena and Carla sign in to manage offers and see the holder.

Clients: personal offer links allow replies without staff access; both screens show the outcome.

Reliability: matching, timeouts, cancellation, one holder and recovery after worker restart.

What is simulated or excluded

No real SMS. Open the client's personal link from the staff demo. The client page is clearly simulated.

No Square connection. Staff update it manually.

Sample waitlist. Live intake and opt-out management remain future work. Staff passwords are local.

A PRACTICAL NEXT STEP

Walk through a real cancellation together.

Lena and Carla can review the local prototype before any real-client pilot.

A focused staff review

1. Pick an opening and explain who should get it first.
2. Try a question, decline, acceptance and cancellation; check the visible result and Square handoff.
3. Agree on practical cutoff guidance and what staff need before using it with real clients.

Then prepare a small pilot

Add live waitlist consent/opt-out handling and SMS with safe retries.
Review staff account support before a pilot.

Measure openings filled, staff checking time and conflicting claims against today's process.